

Consumer Spending & Platforms

Confidential planning brief | Generated for Strategy Task Force review

Published: Q1 2026

Source: Platform Distribution Report

Panel: 72,000 active players

Platforms: Steam, PlayStation, Xbox, Switch

Platform Split & Monetization Mechanics

Platform behavior remains highly genre-specific. Console audiences still over-index for racing, sports, action adventure, and licensed brand experiences where controller comfort and living-room play matter. PC audiences over-index for simulation, strategy, management, modding, creator tools, and long-session customization. Switch remains relevant for cozy, family, and portable-friendly releases, but its technical constraints shape content scope.

Consumer spending is also diverging by trust model. Players are more comfortable paying premium prices for polished, complete launches and more willing to buy expansions when the base game feels generous. The strongest resistance appears around paid cosmetics that arrive before meaningful content, unstable launches with premium editions, and opaque recurring monetization.



Genre	Platform Shape	Spend Pattern	Commercial Note
Racing / driving	Console-heavy, wheel-support enthusiast pocket on PC	Launch-weighted premium sales, modest expansion attach	Strong known buyers, less organic broadening without licenses or esports
Action sports	Balanced PC/console	Premium plus cosmetic packs, event-driven engagement	Benefits from clips, customization, and challenge communities
Life / cozy simulation	PC-led with meaningful console growth	Long-tail expansions, mod-friendly sales, décor and identity packs	High upside if tooling and stability are credible
Strategy / management	PC-heavy	Premium plus expansions, lower cosmetic tolerance	Smaller audience but reliable depth-driven retention
Survival crafting	PC-led, console viable with strong UX	Premium or early-access, high co-op retention	Very competitive; differentiation depends on systems and world identity

Target Audience Quotes

"I buy simulations on PC because mods are half the point."

PC player, 30

"Racing is a console game for me. I want it smooth, quick, and reliable."

Console player, 26

"I do not mind DLC when I can see the studio is adding real systems, not just selling outfits."

Multi-platform player, 33

"If a game has good creator tools, I will watch it before I buy it."

UK player, 21